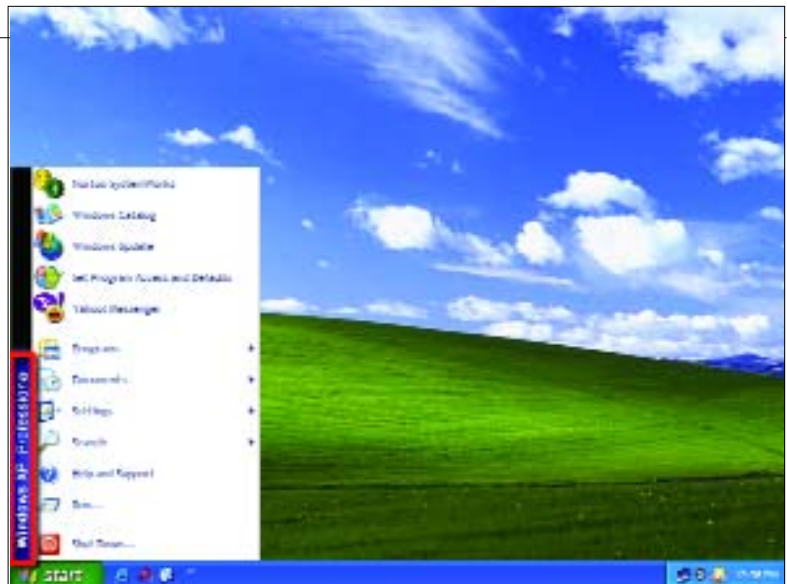


Changing the Windows Logo in the Start Menu

Every month, Digit will pose a question that will set you thinking. Digit challenges you to take a crack at the problem. Send in your answers with your full name, address and contact details to takeacrack@thinkdigit.com. Digit's Test Centre will select the correct answers. In case of multiple correct entries, the winner will be decided by a draw of lots. For starters, we have published the solution to a specific challenge here.



Challenge

In Windows, the name of the OS appears vertically in the Start Menu. Can you change this and put "Digit" there instead? Note that in XP, the change can be seen only if you are using the Classic Start Menu.



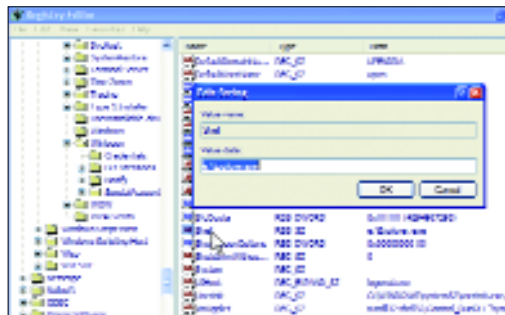
Solution

The text "Windows XP Professional" or "Windows 98" or "Windows 2000" is a bitmap image embedded in explorer.exe. To edit this file, you will need a tool called Resource Hacker. Download it from <http://www.users.on.net/~johnson/resourcehacker/>. Do back up the files you will be changing before you proceed.

Start Resource Hacker, and open C:\windows\explorer.exe. For Windows XP, expand the Bitmap folder in the left pane, expand the 167 folder and then click 1033. In the right pane, you will see the bitmap image with "Windows XP Professional" on it. Right-click 1033 in the left pane, and choose 'Save [Bitmap : 167 : 1033]'. Enter a directory and filename and click OK. For Windows 98 and 2000, go to Bitmap > 157 > 1033 to find the bitmap.

Next, edit the bit map using an image editor such as Photoshop, but do not change its colour depth and dimensions. After you have made the changes, save the file as a bitmap image.

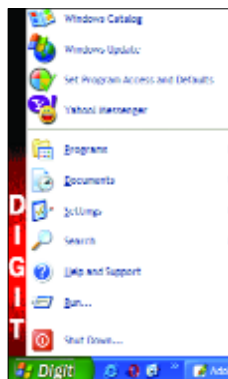
Now, embed this new image into explorer.exe. Keep Resource Hacker open and ensure that the tree (Bitmap > 167 > 1033 for Windows XP, and Bitmap > 157 > 1033 for Windows 98 or 2000) is



Change the value of the Shell key using the registry editor

still expanded. Right-click on 1033 and choose 'Replace Resource'. Next, click 'Open file with new bitmap', point to the edited bitmap and click the Replace button. Now, go to File > Save As and save this file in another location. For example, we saved this file in the E:\ folder as E:\explorer.exe.

Next, in Windows 98, simply restart your computer in MS-DOS mode, and replace C:\windows\ explorer.exe with E:\explorer.exe.



Your Start Menu should look like this

With XP or 2000, you will need to make a few changes to the registry. Go to Start > Run, type 'regedit' and hit [Enter] to open the registry editor. Navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE \SOFTWARE\Microsoft\ Windows NT\Current Version \Winlogon. In the right pane, change the value of the 'Shell' key from Explorer.exe to E:\explorer.exe. This done, restart your computer to view the results.

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4. Jasubhai Digital Media is not responsible for any damage to your system that may be caused while you are solving the problem.

Caution!

Test the edited explorer.exe before you edit the registry in Windows XP or 2000. Press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Esc] to bring up the Task Manager, switch to the Processes tab, right-click explorer and click 'End Process'. Now, go to File > New Task (Run...) and enter e:\explorer.exe or the location of the edited file. If all's well with the file, you see the changes immediately. You can now edit the registry to make the changes permanent. If you use Windows 98, and are unable to boot after replacing the file, press [F8] while booting and choose Command prompt. Here, replace the edited file with its backup and restart the PC.